



LATER

"We'll add real-time later" is the most expensive sentence in a scoping call. It always sounds reasonable.

REAL-TIME ISN'T A FEATURE. IT'S A SHAPE.

01 Normally your app asks for data

02 Real-time means data arrives uninvited

03 That flips who starts the conversation

LATER
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THE COST IS THE UNBUILDING.

Retrofitting doesn't add a feature to your app. It changes how every screen you already built gets its data.

01

DECIDE THE SHAPE, NOT THE FEATURE

You don't have to build chat in week one. You do have to decide whether this app pulls data or gets sent it.

02

NAME THE SCREENS THAT WILL NEVER SIT STILL

Order status, chat, presence, live counts. Name them now, even if they ship in month six.

03

RENT THE PIPE ON DAY ONE

A managed real-time service costs little at MVP scale. Wiring one in early is a small tax. Adding one in month eight is a migration.

RETROFIT

Before: one data path, built once. After:
every screen already reading the old one, re-
opened and re-tested. Same feature — a
different amount of work.



SCOPING A MOBILE MVP?

Save this before you agree to "later".

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I build mobile for startups and post what actually breaks.